

Chana Dal Paratha

Unleavened Bread Stuffed with Bengal Gram

Recipe Details

Recommended Cookware: on 26 cm Futura Hard Anodised Tava (Griddle)

Cooking Time: , mixing after each addition, till dough forms a s

Method

1. To make filling: Bring water to boil in a medium pan on high heat. Add chana dal, salt and turmeric. Stir. Bring to boil. Reduce heat to low. Cover and cook till dal is tender but not mushy (about 35 minutes). Meanwhile, do step 2. Drain off excess water, if any. Allow to cool. Add remaining ingredients. Mix.
2. To make dough: Mix flour, salt, ghee and 1 cup/240 ml water. Add enough of remaining water ($\frac{1}{4}$ cup + 2 tbsp/90 ml), 2 tbsp/30 ml at a time, mixing after each addition, till dough forms a soft ball (stop adding water before dough becomes wet and sticky). Knead till dough is smooth and elastic (about 2 minutes). Keep covered with a damp cloth about 30 minutes.
3. Rub hands with a little ghee. Knead dough briefly. Make 12 balls about $1\frac{1}{2}$ inch/3.8 cm in diameter. Keep covered with a damp cloth.
4. On a floured board, roll each ball of dough into a flat round 4 inch/10 cm in diameter (To prevent sticking when rolling out rounds of dough: slightly flatten balls and press the balls lightly in flour on both sides. Shake off excess flour and roll out). Keep on a lightly floured surface, covered with a damp cloth.
5. To stuff paratha: Follow illustrated steps using $\frac{1}{4}$ cup/60 ml filling for each round of dough.
6. Place round on palm of hand. Cup hand slightly to form a depression in centre of round (Figure A).
7. Put $\frac{1}{4}$ cup/60 ml filling on round. Lightly pat filling, spreading evenly to $\frac{1}{4}$ inch/6 mm from edge of round (Figure B).
8. Surround filling evenly with dough by gently opening and closing hand slightly in a pulsating motion till some edges just meet. Pinch together the edges which meet just enough to seal (Figure C). Pat sealed area to get an even thickness of dough. Repeat till round is closed fully.
9. Place stuffed round on board. Flatten slightly. Stuff remaining rounds of dough in the same way. Keep covered with a damp cloth.
10. On a floured board, roll each stuffed ball gently into a flat round 6 inch/15 cm in diameter. Keep on a lightly floured surface, covered with a damp cloth.
11. Heat tava on medium heat about $1\frac{1}{2}$ minutes for 22 cm tava/about 3 minutes for 26 cm tava.
12. Put round on tava. Cook as explained below. Cook remaining rounds in the same way. Serve hot, accompanied with curd.
13. Put round on preheated tava. Cook 1 minute. (Top should begin to look dry and darken. There should be a few light brown specks on the underside. If you can adjust the heat so that a few brown specks appear on the underside in 1 minute, you will be cooking at the ideal temperature.) Turn over round with a broad spatula.

Hawkins Cookers Limited

Maker Tower F-101, Cuffe Parade, Mumbai 400 005

14. Spread ½ tsp/2.5 ml ghee all over top surface of round. Turn over.

15. Spread ½ tsp/2.5 ml ghee in the same way. Turn over.

16. Lightly press entire round with spatula, rotating and pressing a small area at a time. (Pressing paratha ensures even cooking. If you notice a lighter area, press on the opposite side of that area when you have turned over paratha) Turn over.

17. Press in the same way. Turn over.

18. Spread ½ tsp/2.5 ml ghee over round. Turn over.

19. Spread ½ tsp/2.5 ml ghee over round. Turn over.

20. Continue pressing and turning till paratha is evenly browned (medium-brown) on both sides. Remove.

Source

Recipe sourced from official Hawkins cookbook collection (All Indian Cookbook / Miss Mary Cookbook series).